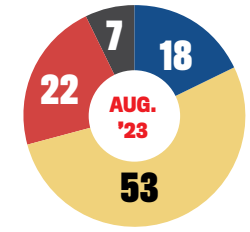
those in January 2021 (55 per cent); in fact, the share of those who feel it has deteriorated has increased from 22 per cent to 34.1 per cent in August 2023. A quarter (25.3 per cent) of the respondents feel that the Bharatiya Janata Party-Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (BJP-RSS) combine is responsible for the deteriorating scenario, while 1.8 per cent and 1.7 per cent blame religious fundamental groups and the media (both mainstream and social), respectively.

Perceptions about Muslims, India's largest minority group, are also shifting. A vast majority of the respondents—69.1 per cent—feel Muslims in India are safe. The view that Muslim men are indulging in 'love jihad' by marrying Hindu women has also waned slightly, from 53.1 per cent in January 2023 to 44.6 per cent now. Those who think the hijab should be banned number 49 per cent today, compared to 56.6 per cent in January 2023. Separately, while almost 30 per cent of respondents support inter-religious marriages, 41.5 per cent support it only conditionally, that is, if the religious identity is known to both parties. Over half of Christian respondents (55 per cent) and 40 per cent Sikhs support inter-religious marriages too. Those opposing it as a whole are on the decline, from 23.8 per cent of the respondents in January this year to 16.7 per cent in the latest survey.

As an extension of these subjects then, the proposal for a Uniform Civil Code (UCC) also seems to have become a point of debate. The code will cover areas like marriage, divorce, maintenance, inheritance, adoption and succession of property, and will imply that all sections of society, irrespective of their religion, will be subject to a uniform, common set of laws. Interestingly, the share of those who want a UCC has declined from 72.7 per cent in the MOTN poll of

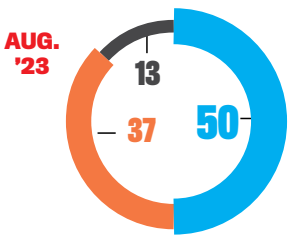
Q. What do you think of politicians heading sports federations?



There is nothing wrong with it | They should head only if they have experience in that particular sport | Politicians must stay away from sports | DK/CS

Most feel politicians heading sports bodies must have prior experience in the respective sports

Q. Do you think the Election Commission is impartial?



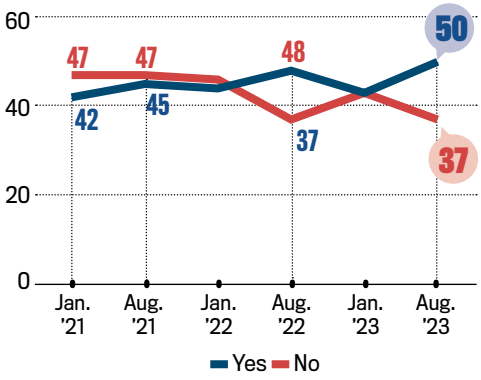
Yes | No | DK/CS

Half the people vouch for the ECI's impartiality, but many express doubts

55%

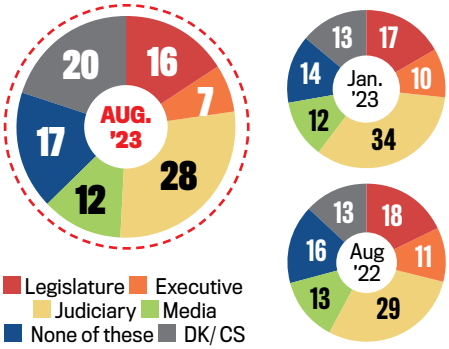
THE SHARE OF MUSLIMS WHO ARE AGAINST IMPLEMENTING A UNIFORM CIVIL CODE; 50 PER CENT CHRISTIANS ALSO OPPOSE IT

Q. Do you think democracy is in danger in India?



The percentage of people who think democracy in India stands endangered has been rising steadily

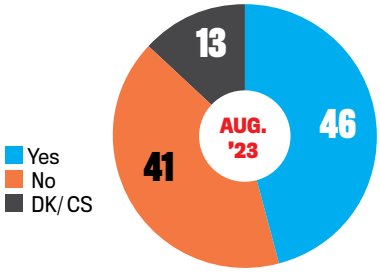
Q. Which of the four pillars of democracy do you think has best upheld democratic norms in India?



Legislature | Executive | Judiciary | Media | None of these | DK/CS

The judiciary consistently gets top billing as the custodian of India's democratic traditions

Q. Do you think the Union government has done enough to protect your privacy in the digital space?



Yes
No
DK/CS

More people may express confidence in the government's efforts to protect privacy, but enough are worried too

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS (don't know/can't say)